

Why Apple WWDC 2025 may be more important than you think

Apple's Worldwide Developers Conference (WWDC) has long been considered one of the least exciting events in the company's annual lineup. Most announcements at WWDC focus on software and cater more to developers than end users. But this year, things are different. WWDC 2025 might just be Apple's most significant event in years, thanks to one crucial factor: Artificial Intelligence.

Apple has taken a measured approach to AI, integrating machine learning and on-device intelligence subtly into its ecosystem. Features like Siri, Apple's Neural Engine, and computational photography have all used AI in some capacity, but the company has been hesitant to go all-in on generative AI, until recently. Largely, because it was forced to by the competition.

At WWDC 2024, Apple finally unveiled its AI strategy under the banner of "Apple Intelligence." It was positioned as the company's answer to Google's Gemini, Microsoft's Copilot, and OpenAI's ChatGPT. However, despite the big reveal, Apple Intelligence has faced delays, limited rollouts, and underwhelming capabilities compared to its rivals.

In contrast, Google has aggressively expanded Gemini's integration into Android and its suite of apps, while Microsoft has seamlessly embedded AI into Windows and Office. Even Samsung, Apple's biggest competitor in the hardware space, has leaned into AI-powered smartphones with its Galaxy AI features. This leaves Apple in a spot of bother, and WWDC 2025 is the company's opportunity to change the narrative.

This year's WWDC keynote will start on June 9. Traditionally, Apple has used this event to unveil its latest software updates: iOS, iPadOS, macOS, watchOS, and tvOS. However, in 2025, users would need more than just incremental updates.

Apple Intelligence, which was expected to launch across iPhones, iPads, and Macs in a meaningful way, still lacks the deep integra-



"If Apple fails to deliver a compelling AI vision at WWDC 2025, it risks losing its reputation as a technology leader."

Manas Tiwari
Technology Editor,
Times Network



Want to share your thoughts, write to :
editor@digit.in

tion and capabilities that users have come to expect from AI-powered tools. For instance, Siri remains far behind Google's Gemini in conversational abilities, and Apple's AI-driven Clean-Up feature feels underwhelming against the Magic Eraser on Pixel and Samsung Galaxy phones.

If Apple can demonstrate significant advancements in these areas at WWDC 2025, it could signal a major shift in how its devices compete in the AI landscape.

Another reason WWDC 2025 holds more weight than previous years is the hardware factor. Apple has been building AI-ready devices for a while, with its latest A-series and M-series chips featuring enhanced neural processing capabilities. The iPhone 17 lineup, expected later this year, will be another step in that direction.

At WWDC, Apple could announce optimisations that allow Apple Intelligence to run more efficiently on-device. Additionally, there's speculation that macOS could receive significant AI-driven updates, making MacBooks smarter and more intuitive for professionals and creatives alike.

Apple has always been known for its tight integration of hardware, software, and services. With WWDC 2025, the company has an opportunity to extend this synergy into AI-driven experiences across its ecosystem by introducing AI-driven experiences for services such as Apple Music or Apple TV+. This could be a key differentiator, as Apple's competitors largely rely on partnerships and third-party services to deliver AI capabilities.

Apple has a lot riding on WWDC this year. Consumers are now actively seeking AI-powered features in their smartphones, laptops, and everyday apps. If Apple fails to deliver a compelling AI vision at WWDC 2025, it risks losing its reputation as a tech leader and its hold over the premium market segment.

WWDC 2025 may have once been an event only developers cared about, but this year, the whole world will be watching. **d**